



Intel Moorestown

What's that?

The latest design architecture from Intel, Moorestown will be used in the Ultra Mobile PCs (UMPCs) and Mobile Internet Devices (MID) of the future.

Why are we talking about it?

The platform is touted as being a "system on a chip"; it will include a powerful 45nm processor core and the graphics and memory controllers on a single die. It consists of two parts: a flexible die design that can include dual-core processors if needed, and an I/O chip that provides connectivity to an inbuilt graphics accelerator. It can also support a DDR3 memory controller, PCI-Express, USB, SATA, and WiMAX.

Where is this headed?

The future of MIDs and UMPCs depends heavily on platforms that can handle computation-heavy tasks while being energy-efficient, since the trend is that of tasks traditionally carried out on a computer shifting to mobile devices.

Who would be interested?

Everyone from HTC (high-end phone designers and manufacturers) to Palm to Nokia. Those into operating systems—like Microsoft and Canonical (the developers of Ubuntu)—are also looking at this with great interest—they'd want a slice of the pie, of course.

How will this affect us??

This is speculation, but it does seem that everything you currently do on your computer will be possible on the mobile, from browsing HTML Web sites and watching HD movies to using GPS. Moreover, the devices will run at least 20 times longer than the current generation of mobile phones, according to Intel.

When can we start playing with these devices?

Not anytime soon. The launch date for the platform is expected to be around the middle of 2010.

details of protocols which would enable servers made by rivals to interoperate seamlessly with Windows. An appeals court ordered the company to remedy the situation by sharing the relevant data. This Microsoft delayed, and as a result, the market share of other companies shrunk to nearly zero, while sales of Microsoft servers (SQL Server, Exchange Server) surged. Samba was the only open source alternative in the market—and it survived.

Now with much-needed documentation, which it acquired for ₹ 0,000 (Rs 5.7 lakh), Samba will be able to work on Windows without any glitches. The documentation will be kept confidential, though the source code for the applications that use these protocols would be released under the GPL.

In fact, Microsoft's seems to be abandoning its strategy of running roughshod over the competition, and seems—just seems—to be becoming more reasonable. The new IE8 has passed the Acid 2 test, which determines whether browsers adhere to the official W3C (World Wide Web Consortium) standards. This is good news for millions of Web developers, who have been forced to make different versions of the same Web site for IE and non-IE browsers. Besides, previous iterations of Internet Explorer had plenty of security holes, and one way of sweeping away the detritus would be by following accepted standards. This announcement was probably related to Opera filing a complaint against Microsoft accusing it of using non-standard protocols that force Web sites to follow suit, thus putting other browsers at a disadvantage.

Microsoft is sometimes called the Evil Empire: it is

finally getting mellow? The jury is still pondering about this one...

MAKING A DIFFERENCE

Games For The Good

The number of games in the market that feature violence and gore, primarily to stand out in the crowd and attract fans, has been steadily increasing. Some are so disturbing that censors have fought to prevent their release: a case in point is *Manhunt 2*'s troubles with British regulators. Efforts are on, though, to harness the

players towards developing a social conscience. The lab will interact with game designers, educators, and other stakeholders to design games like *~Ayiti: The Cost of Life~*, where players need to manage the day-to-day life of a family of five in Haiti. In a typical scenario, players might be expected to decide on whether to throw a bash or buy healthy food. Such games might also take elements from city simulation games like the *~SimCity~* series and teach players how to do things like reducing global warming and curbing wasteful food habits.

Backed by a \$4,50,000 (Rs 1.8 crore) grant from the MacArthur foundation,



potent visualisation and interactivity of computer games in other, more socially beneficial ways.

Games that simulate terrorist attacks and hostage crises have been long used by law enforcement agencies to train personnel. There's a problem with these games, though—they are so niche, they don't appeal to mainstream gamers. To remedy the situation, a prestigious New York-based Parsons The New School of Design has recently launched PETLab, comprising its faculty and students, to study how playing games might push

PETLab is in collaboration with *Games for Change*, a non-profit that supports serious game designers, and think.MTV.com, MTV's socially-oriented Web site. It is also negotiating with Microsoft to determine whether the Xbox's game development tool could be used to create games in these genres.

The news that games can heal has been much in the news the past two years, and no-one now doubts that games can be used for more than entertainment. These new initiatives, though, don't sound entirely convincing, but we won't be downright pessimistic. ■